

Production Readiness Audit

Everything preventing a public launch of gradpilotai.com

Next.js on Vercel · Supabase · audited against live code & database · 20 June 2026

VERDICT

NOT ready for public launch. The marketing site is solid, but it **advertises AI features that do not exist yet** (CV coach, AI adviser, interview prep), has **no payments**, **no analytics**, and **no error pages**. These are launch blockers. Good news: the database schema is complete and the backend is secure — the work is wiring features, not rebuilding.

Readiness scorecard

Area	Status	One-line summary
Marketing site	GOOD	Landing, jobs, blog, mentors, pricing, FAQ all render real data.
Database schema	GOOD	All 33 tables exist incl. product tables; backend hardened.
Core AI product	MISSING	CV coach, adviser, interview prep advertised but not built.
Payments	MISSING	No Stripe; "Upgrade to Pro" just links to signup.
Error handling	MISSING	No error/loading pages; default Next.js crash screen.
Analytics	MISSING	Zero tracking — no GA4/PostHog/Vercel Analytics.
Security	MINOR	2 advisor items; weak min password length.
SEO	PARTIAL	Good metadata; no OG image or structured data.
Performance	PARTIAL	All pages force-dynamic; no caching/ISR; unoptimised images.
Mobile	LIKELY OK	Responsive Tailwind throughout; not device-tested.

1 • Broken / non-functional features

Feature	Problem	Sev.
AI CV coach	Advertised on homepage & pricing; no feature exists . cvs table empty. Promising a feature you can't deliver is a trust/refund risk.	BLOCKER
AI career adviser	Headline feature on homepage; not built . ai_conversations table empty/unused.	BLOCKER
Interview prep	Advertised; 36 questions sit in DB but no UI . interview_prep_sessions empty.	BLOCKER
Upgrade to Pro / payments	Pricing & CTAs say "Upgrade to Pro" but link to /signup — no Stripe, no charge . subscriptions empty.	BLOCKER
Save & track a job	Job detail "Save & track this job" links to /signup; never saves . saved_jobs & applications empty/unused.	HIGH
Dashboard applications	"Your applications" is hardcoded to "none yet" — never reads the applications table.	HIGH
Find a mentor	Mentor cards show but there's no contact/booking flow . mentor_requests unused.	MED
Job alerts	job_alerts / visa_deadline_alerts tables exist; no UI or sending .	LOW

2 • Incomplete pages

Page	What's missing
/dashboard	Just navigation cards + a hardcoded empty state. No real user data, saved jobs, applications, CV, or activity.
/about	Prose only. Does not render the team_members rows; no team section, no contact details.
Profile / settings	Does not exist . Users can't edit name, change password, set preferences, or delete their account (GDPR concern).
Onboarding	Does not exist . No capture of degree, field, visa status — so nothing can be personalised.
Product pages	No pages for CV analysis, adviser chat, interview practice, applications board, or saved jobs.
Legal pages	No Privacy Policy, Terms, or Cookie policy page — required before collecting data publicly .
Contact / support	No contact page; support_tickets table exists but unused.

3 · Database tables — status

No tables are missing. All 33 expected tables exist with RLS enabled. The issue is that the **product tables are empty and unused** — the app never reads or writes them. Wiring features to these tables is the core build work.

Table	Rows	State
jobs / employer_insights / blog_posts / mentors / faqs / pricing_plans / testimonials / interview_questions	30 / 26 / 10 / 10 / 8 / 3 / 8 / 36	LIVE
profiles	2	LIVE
waitlist_submissions	1	LIVE
team_members	4	3 PLACEHOLDER
saved_jobs · applications · cvs · ai_conversations · subscriptions · interview_prep_sessions · mentor_requests · job_alerts · visa_deadline_alerts · notifications · support_tickets · usage_tracking · room_listings	0 (all)	EXISTS · UNUSED

4 · Placeholder / unverified content

- **team_members:** 3 “TBC” rows (Head of Product, Lead Engineer, COO) seeded from the old prototype — remove or replace with real people.
- **Promotional claim:** “3 months of Pro free for early members” appears on the homepage — make sure that's an intended, honourable offer.
- **Testimonials (8):** imported from the Base44 prototype — confirm these are real, consented quotes before showing them publicly (legal risk if invented).
- **Pricing fallback:** a hardcoded Free/Pro fallback exists in code; ensure the live pricing_plans rows are the intended, final prices.
- **About page:** founder story is generic (“founded by an international student”) — add real names/specifics for credibility.

5 · Missing error handling

- **No error.tsx / global-error.tsx:** any unhandled render error shows the raw Next.js error screen — no branding, no recovery.
- **No loading.tsx:** dynamic pages (jobs, blog, mentors) have no loading skeletons — users see a blank pause while Supabase responds.
- **Silent empty states:** queries fail soft to empty arrays (good for stability) but several pages then render nothing with no “couldn't load” message.
- **Auth callback:** redirects to /login?error=auth on failure, but the login page **doesn't display** that error param — user gets no feedback.
- **Forms:** waitlist & auth show generic errors; no field-level validation feedback or retry guidance.

6 · Security issues

Issue	Detail & fix	Sev.
Leaked-password protection OFF	Supabase Auth HaveIBeenPwned check disabled. One-click enable in Auth settings.	HIGH
Weak min password	Signup allows 6-char passwords. Raise to 8+ and add strength guidance.	MED
No rate limiting	Waitlist & auth forms have no throttling/CAPTCHA — open to spam/abuse. Add Supabase rate limits or hCaptcha.	MED
No legal/consent	Collecting emails with no Privacy Policy or cookie consent — UK GDPR exposure. ICO registration still PENDING.	HIGH
is_admin() executable	Advisor warning; required by RLS policies — by design, safe.	LOW
Anon key in repo	Hardcoded fallback in lib/env.ts — public/RLS-protected by design, but rotate if ever misused.	LOW

Backend is otherwise in good shape: RLS enabled on every table; security advisors down to 2 (one by-design, one one-click).

7 · Mobile responsiveness

The codebase uses responsive Tailwind breakpoints throughout (sm: / md: / lg: grids, stacked hero CTAs, sticky sidebar that collapses). **No structural red flags**, but it has **not been tested on real devices**. Before launch, manually check: nav/header on small screens, long job titles & tables, form inputs (font-size $\geq 16\text{px}$ to avoid iOS zoom), and tap-target sizes.

8 · Performance issues

- **Everything is force-dynamic:** every page (even rarely-changing blog/jobs/pricing) hits Supabase on every request. Switch content pages to ISR (revalidate) for big speed + cost wins.
- **Unoptimised images:** avatars use raw `<img>` (eslint-disabled) instead of `next/image` — no resizing, lazy-loading or modern formats.
- **No caching headers / CDN strategy** beyond Vercel defaults for dynamic routes.
- **No bundle/Lighthouse budget** tracked. Run Lighthouse before launch to baseline LCP/CLS.

9 · Missing SEO settings

Item	Status / action
Title/description/OG tags	Present & good (root + blog). ✓
sitemap.xml / robots.txt	Present & dynamic. ✓
OG / social share image	Missing — no opengraph-image, so links share with no preview card. Add one (static or generated).
Twitter card metadata	Missing — add twitter card fields.
Structured data (JSON-LD)	Missing — add JobPosting (huge for Google Jobs), Article (blog), FAQPage (faq).
Per-page canonical URLs	Missing — add canonical tags to avoid duplicate-content dilution.
Per-page metadata	Static pages have basic metadata; job/mentor detail pages lack dynamic titles/descriptions.

10 · Missing analytics

There is no analytics of any kind. No GA4, no PostHog, no Vercel Analytics, no conversion or funnel tracking, no error monitoring (e.g. Sentry). Launching without this means **zero visibility** into traffic, sign-up conversion, drop-off, or runtime errors. Add at minimum: (1) a product analytics tool (PostHog or GA4), (2) Vercel Web Analytics, and (3) error monitoring (Sentry).

11 · Launch-blocker checklist (do these before going public)

#	Blocker	Owner
1	Resolve the “advertised but missing” AI features — either build a first version OR soften the marketing copy to “coming soon”. Shipping false claims is the #1 risk.	Me
2	Add Stripe checkout + webhooks so “Upgrade to Pro” actually charges and sets subscriptions.	Me
3	Add analytics + error monitoring (PostHog/GA4 + Vercel Analytics + Sentry).	Me
4	Add error.tsx, global-error.tsx, loading.tsx and a login error display.	Me
5	Publish Privacy Policy, Terms & cookie consent; complete ICO registration.	You + Me
6	Enable leaked-password protection; raise min password length; add form rate-limiting.	Me
7	Replace/remove the 3 “TBC” team members; verify testimonials are real & consented.	You + Me
8	Add OG image + JSON-LD structured data; switch content pages to ISR.	Me
9	Wire “Save & track job” + dashboard applications to the real tables (or hide the buttons).	Me
10	Manual mobile QA + Lighthouse pass; then turn OFF Vercel Deployment Protection.	Me

Bottom line: don't open the doors yet. The site looks finished but promises AI features it can't deliver, can't take payment, and is invisible to analytics with no error pages or legal cover. None of this needs a rebuild — the schema and backend are ready. The honest fastest path to launch: **(a)** soften copy to “coming soon” for unbuilt features OR build their first versions, **(b)** wire Stripe + analytics + error pages + legal, then **(c)** flip the site public. I can start on the “Me” items immediately.